

Venture capital is a relatively young industry, intimately entwined with Silicon Valley. While Silicon Valley made venture capital the famous industry it is today, venture capital made Silicon Valley. One of the earliest and most widely recognized companies that helped jump-start the venture capital industry was Intel, which today produces the chips in most of our computers. The company was started in Santa Clara, California, by well-known and highly regarded scientists, Gordon E. Moore (famous for creating “Moore’s Law”¹) and Robert Noyce (cocreator of the integrated circuit), but they were hard-pressed to raise money for their new company. Ultimately, Intel found a benefactor in Arthur Rock—an American financier who coined the term *venture capitalist*²—who helped them raise \$2.5 million in convertible debentures that included \$10,000 from his own pocket.³ The company went public two years later in 1970, raising \$6.8 million and providing significant rewards to Rock and those who bought the debentures. Intel was one of the first companies to utilize venture capital as a method of funding its startup, and due to its success, helped pioneer the concept in Silicon Valley.

Despite the relative youth of venture capital, many cryptoasset firms are now turning the model on its head. The disruptors are in danger of being disrupted. For the innovative investor, it’s key to realize that cryptoassets are not only making it easier for driven entrepreneurs to raise money, they’re also creating opportunities for the average investor to get into the earliest rounds of what could be the next Facebook